	DOCUMENT CONTROL	
	Document no: ASMF 8.4	
Compiled by:	**Sifiso Nyambi - Laboratory Manager**	
Approved by:	**Nonhlanhla Msibi - Operations Manager**	

Contents

1. INTRODUCTION 2
2. SCOPE 2
3. RESPONSIBILITIES 3
4. PROCEDURE 4
4.1 Checking and approval of adequacy 5
4.2 Identification of changes, reasons and revision codes 5
4.3 Issuing new or amended documents to point of use 5
4.4 Maintaining legibility and accuracy of issued documents 5
4.5 Identification, retrieval and disposal of obsolete documents 6
4.6 Periodic document review 6
4.7 Re-issue of documents 6
4.8 Use of approved documents 6
4.9 Master List of Documents 7
5. REFERENCES 8
6. Revisions 8

Effective date	Rev status	Next review date
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1. INTRODUCTION

It is company policy to operate a document control system that supports and governs all activities performed by Azuresky (Pty) Ltd, including:

- testing activities in accordance with ISO/IEC 17025:2017,
- proficiency testing scheme activities in accordance with ISO/IEC 17043:2023
- reference material production activities in accordance with ISO/IEC 17034:2016.

This document control system ensures that procedures, methods, forms and records required for testing, proficiency testing scheme operation and reference material production are established, implemented, maintained and controlled in accordance with the requirements of the applicable international standards.

2. SCOPE

This procedure applies to all documents necessary to ensure the effective planning, operation and control of:

- testing activities performed in accordance with ISO/IEC 17025:2017,
- proficiency testing scheme activities in accordance with ISO/IEC 17043:2023, and
- reference material production activities in accordance with ISO/IEC 17034:2016.
- This includes but is not limited to:
- test methods and work instructions,
- sampling and sample preparation procedures,
- calculation and reporting procedures,

- quality control procedures,
- proficiency testing and reference material production procedures, and
- supporting quality management system documents.

3. RESPONSIBILITIES

Any document changes or modifications that are proposed and subsequently implemented are controlled as follows:

The Operations Manager is responsible for the authorization and issue of all controlled documents relating to:

- testing activities (ISO/IEC 17025),
- proficiency testing scheme activities (ISO/IEC 17043), and
- reference material production activities (ISO/IEC 17034).

Each controlled document shall include

- Revision status
- Summary of changes
- Requested by
- Authorized by

The Laboratory Manager is responsible for ensuring that current and approved documents applicable to testing activities are available at the point of use.

4. PROCEDURE

The documentation defining the Quality Management System for testing, proficiency testing scheme operation and reference material production is controlled.

The company operates a system of document control for procedures, test methods, standards and forms that enables the following:

- All documentation relating to testing, PT scheme and RM production is reviewed for adequacy before approval by authorized personnel.
- Document amendments shall show evidence of change or modification.
- Deleted words shall be denoted by strikethrough and changes highlighted.
- Identification of reasons for changes and assignment of revision codes.
- Issuing of new or amended documents to the point of use, including laboratory testing areas.
- Maintaining legibility and accuracy of issued documents.
- Ensuring controlled status of externally sourced documents, including test method standards.
- Identification and controlled retention or disposal of obsolete documentation.
- Periodic review of documents to ensure continued suitability for testing, PT and RM activities.
- Re-issue of documents after a practical number of changes have been made.
- Ensuring that only approved documents are used for testing, PT scheme and RM production activities.

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4.1 Checking and approval of adequacy

All documents relating to testing, proficiency testing scheme and reference material production shall be reviewed for adequacy before approval by the Operations Manager.

4.2 Identification of changes, reasons and revision codes

Changes to documents are recorded in the amendment table of the respective document.
The new revision number, date of revision and reason for change are clearly identified.

4.3 Issuing new or amended documents to point of use

The Operations Manager issues new or revised documents to the point of use, including laboratory testing areas.
The Master Copy of the previous revision is withdrawn and filed.
The Laboratory Manager signs acceptance of the new revision and ensures disposal of obsolete copies.

4.4 Maintaining legibility and accuracy of issued documents

The Operations Manager is responsible for reviewing and authorizing documents for legibility and accuracy prior to issue.

Effective date	Rev status	Next review date
06/2026	02	06/2029

4.5 Identification, retrieval and disposal of obsolete documents

The Laboratory Manager identifies obsolete documents during routine or formal review.
Obsolete documents are withdrawn from points of use, marked as obsolete and retained for a minimum of three years.
Electronic documents are backed up on the company file server and retained for a minimum of five years.

4.6 Periodic document review

The Laboratory Manager and Operations Manager conduct formal reviews of all controlled documents relating to testing, PT scheme and RM production at least every five years or when codes of practice or standards change.
Document reviews are also performed during internal and external audits.

4.7 Re-issue of documents

Documents are re-issued after a practical number of changes have been made.
The Operations Manager is responsible for re-issue.

4.8 Use of approved documents

Only approved documents shall be used for:
• testing activities,
• proficiency testing scheme activities, and
• reference material production activities.

Internal audits shall verify that only approved documents are in use.

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4.9 Master List of Documents

A Master List of documents shall be maintained to identify the status of all controlled documentation.

Each document shall be assigned a unique reference code as follows:

Quality Manual – ASDP
Production Procedures, policies – ASMF
Technical Forms – AS…TF
Management forms, Memorandum – AS…MF

Work Instructions – WI

Risk assessment – ASRI

Register – R

External Register – RI

HR doc (training matrix, job description) – ASHR

Assessments – AZCA

Internal Audit plan – AUI

Uncertainty Budget – UB

Proficiency Testing Plan – QMS-AS…PT

Ensuring Validity of results – AS…V

These procedures ensure that applicable documents for testing, PT scheme and RM production are available at all locations where operations are performed and that obsolete documents are removed from use.

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5. REFERENCES

- ISO/IEC 17025:2017 clause 8.3
- ISO/IEC 17034:2016 clause 8.4
- ISO/IEC 17043:2023 clause 8.3

6. Revisions

Date	Rev.	Compiler	Remarks
05/02/2025	01	Sifiso Nyambi	Update the procedure to include ISO 17025 testing requirements, since it only covered PT and CRM activities only.
11/06/2026	02	N Msibi	Section 4.6 updated with more unique reference codes to be applied on controlled documents

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